



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Who's paying attention to who at the party?



Learning Outcome:

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Can Do Statements:

- I can change topics.
- I can talk about social activities.
- I can talk about things that are happening now.

Ask your partner:

- When was the last time you attended an important event?
- How did you feel? What did you talk about?



Let's Explore!

The party's in full swing*!

* "In full swing" means at the most effective or highest level of operation or activity.



Instructions: Read the dialog aloud.

Peter: Hey Renata. How's the party going?

Renata: It's in full swing, Peter! There's a lot of positive energy in here.

Peter: Ricardo Verde is doing a fantastic job as MC. But how's your job going? I hear you saved the day! I'm glad we avoided a disaster. Did I ever tell you about the time I got a job in Hawaii and ...

Renata: Stick to the point, Pete!

Peter: Yeah, so ... Being a doorman isn't bad. I'm getting to meet many beautiful women without seeming flirtatious.

Renata: You're never flirtatious. But I'm glad you're enjoying your role.

Peter: Speaking of roles, how's the fashion show? I just heard Miranda's modeling some of Holly's clothes.

Renata: Excellent vibes and a well-planned ceremony.
Broadcasting both events at the same time brings an international status to Holly's clothing line.

Peter: Oh, while you're at it ... Have you seen Miranda?

Renata: She's right there ... and let me tell you, she looks tremendous! She could be a model herself.

Peter: Wow! She does look good. Oh, check it out ... that Ricardo guy is flirting with her. He was rude to her just the other day.

Renata: Showbiz, Peter. He is trying to maintain his ego. Are you jealous?

Peter: Me? Jealous? I'm just being protective.

Renata: Ok. Enough talk - let's eat!





Let's Practice!

Let's talk about the party!

Instructions: Underline the correct answer. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- 1) Wow, this party is in full *swing* - *ceremony* - *vibes*.
- 2) There's a lot of *ceremony* - *show biz* - *positive energy* in here.
- 3) Being a doorman isn't bad, as I'm *get to meet* - *getting to meet* - *positive energy* many beautiful women.
- 4) Broadcasting the events will give Holly international *vibes* - *show biz* - *status*.



Let's Practice!

How's the party going*?

* "How's (it) going" is an informal way of asking how something is progressing or how something is.

Instructions: Match the words on the right to their corresponding half on the left. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

- | | |
|-----------------------------|-----------------------------|
| 1) Ricardo Verde is | a) some of Holly's clothes. |
| 2) I'm just | b) your role. |
| 3) How's your job | c) going? |
| 4) I'm glad you're enjoying | d) being protective. |
| 5) Miranda's modeling | e) doing a fantastic job. |





Extension Activity

Practice changing topics!

*Instructions: Complete the following steps.
Fill in the Self-Assessment.*

- You are going to play a game with your partner.
- Before you start, write 4-5 different topics for a conversation on cards. Do the same for changing the topic expressions.
- You are going to start by telling a story about something that happened to you recently.
- Your partner will pick a "conversation card" and a "changing the topic card". He or she will change the topic of the conversation.
- Do this until you run out of cards.
- You can also use vocabulary you learned from the lesson to review words. Then, before changing topics, you also need to pick a vocabulary card and raise a new topic related to that word.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write conversation topics and expressions to change topics.

☐☐

I tell a story to a partner.

☐☐

I change topics in a conversation

☐☐

I use vocabulary I learned.

☐☐

Target Words

- **vibe** (noun)
a general feeling you get from a place
e.g. The party had a good vibe.
- **status** (noun)
a high social position that makes other people respect or admire you
e.g. The events will bring an international status to Holly's clothing line.
- **positive energy** (expression)
a feeling of well-being
e.g. There's a lot of positive energy in here.
- **showbiz** (noun)
the entertainment industry
e.g. This is part of showbiz, Peter.
- **get to meet** (expression)
to have the opportunity to interact with people
e.g. I get to meet many beautiful women here.
- **ceremony** (noun)
a formal public event with special traditions, actions, or words
e.g. This is a very well-planned ceremony.



Learning Points

The Present Continuous

The present continuous tense (also called the present progressive tense) is a tense commonly used in English. This is how we form and use this tense.

Form: subject + be + verb -ing

Example:

He is trying to maintain his ego.

Use:

1. We use the present continuous to talk about actions or situations which are in progress at the moment of speaking.
 - He is doing a fantastic job at the party.
 - She's really enjoying her new role.
 - I'm just being protective of you.
 - He is flirting with her.
2. We use the present continuous to talk about actions or situations which are in progress around the present time, but not necessarily at the moment of speaking.
 - I'm getting to meet a lot of people at the party.
 - Maria is modelling some of their new clothes.

Expressions for changing conversation topics.

When speaking a foreign language, especially English, it is important that you acquire a set of conversation strategies which will help you deal with the spontaneity of spoken English. A very important strategy you need to master is changing topics in a conversation. Here are a few expressions you can use to change the subject of a conversation.

- But ... + question.
- Funny you should say that. *Did I ever tell you* about the time + clause?
- *Speaking of* + noun, + new topic.
- Oh, *while you're at it*, + new topic.
- Oh, + new topic

Examples

- **Amy:** Hey, are you enjoying the party?
Brian: Yes, but ... is Maria coming?
- **Amy:** There's a lot of good food here.
Brian: Speaking of food, did I tell you about the new Japanese restaurant downtown?
- Oh, check it out! Mark is chatting with the secretary.

